> weeded out from the trial courts because of the long period of time that has elapsed. In several cases, we issued summons to witnesses only to learn that the individuals concerned had died many years ago.

In the end Justice Dhingra made some very pertinent remarks.

> I do not believe that a conviction in a ghastly crime or massacre, after 30 or 40 years having lapsed, amounts to justice. After such a long time, most of those who had lost their loved ones had died too. To those who are alive, how do you justify a sentence after 35 years? How do you call it justice? Justice after 35 years may make for good headlines for you people in the media, but for a human being who has lost everything because of that riot, it will mean nothing.' [10]



On 3 November 1984, with the SBB guard in place at my residence, I accompanied my car pool friends to office. On our way we saw some burnt taxis on Lodhi Road, presumably owned by Sikhs. But there were no dead bodies, which might have been removed from the scene. I told my car pool friends what I had heard on the police wireless network the previous two days and nights. Amar Bhushan still remembers this and also the incident of the young Hindu gentleman stopping us from going towards the INA bridge on the evening of 31 October. [11]

The anti-Sikh pogrom of November 1984 resulted in the death of about 2,800 Sikhs in Delhi and 3,350 nationwide (according to government estimates), while independent sources estimate the number of deaths to be not less than 8,000, with some placing it closer to 15,000. The Congress party won the general elections held in November 1984 with a thumping majority, because the Sikhs of Delhi and some other cities had been taught a lesson of their lifetime.